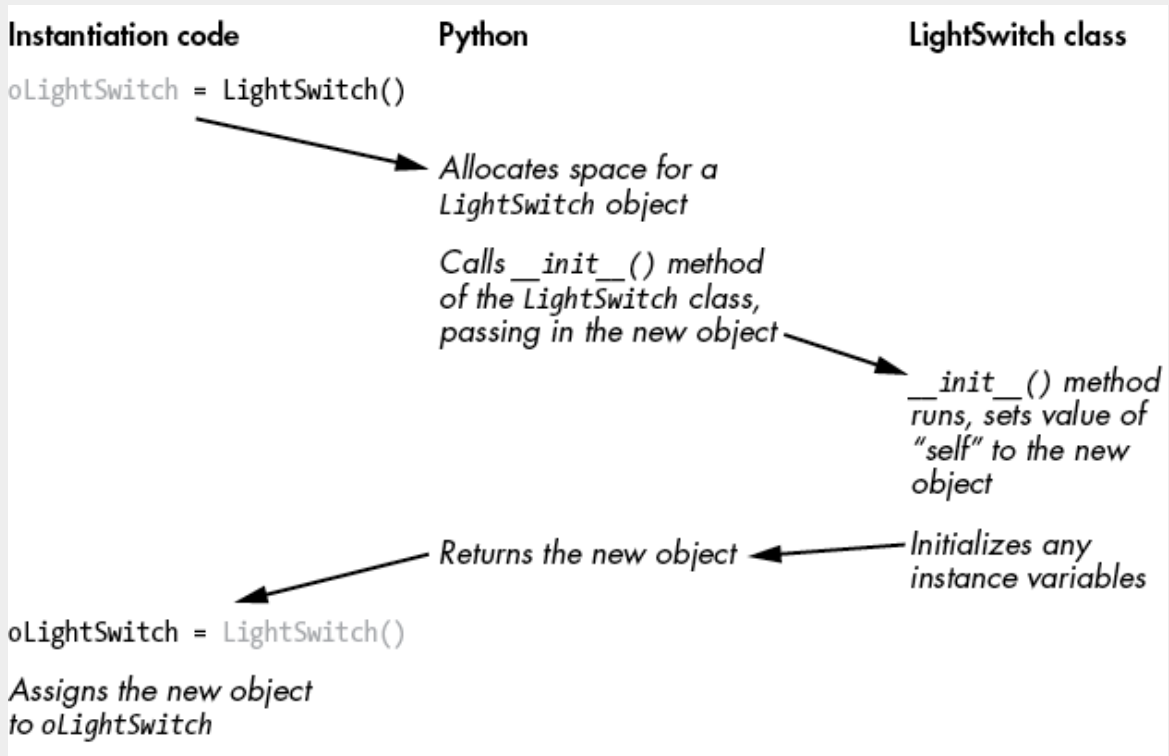


THE INSTANTIATION PROCESS

[Figure 2-3](#) shows the steps involved in instantiating a `LightSwitch` object from the `LightSwitch` class, going from the assignment statement into Python, then to the code of the class, then back out through Python again, and finally back to the assignment statement.



[Figure 2-3](#): The process of instantiating an object

The process consists of five steps:

1. Our code asks Python to create an object from the `LightSwitch` class.
2. Python allocates space in memory for a `LightSwitch` object, then calls the `__init__()` method of the `LightSwitch` class, passing in the newly created object.
3. The `__init__()` method of the `LightSwitch` class runs. The new object is assigned to the parameter `self`. The code of `__init__()` initializes any instance variables in the object (in this case, the instance variable `self.switchIsOn`).
4. Python returns the new object to the original caller.
5. The result of the original call is assigned into the variable `oLightSwitch`, so it now represents the object.